positive connotation, it means nations which object to lining up for war purposes, to military blocs, to military alliances and the like. We keep away from such an approach and want to throw our weight in favour of peace".[6] Krishna Menon, once replying to a reporter's insistent questioning said, "Yes, in a sense non-alignment is an ugly word; it is a negative word but when you use it in the way we do, it becomes positive". Professor J. Bandyopadhyaya contends that the negative nomenclature bears the imprint of India's cultural heritage, which expresses many positive values in the negative terminology.

Nehru, the architect of non-alignment, once said, "I have not originated non-alignment; it is a policy inherent in the circumstances of India for freedom, and inherent in the very circumstances of the world today".[7] He also confessed to the Indian National Assembly that "the natural result of our non-alignment has been that neither of the big blocs looks upon us with favour. They think that we are undependable, because we cannot be made to vote this way or that way". Krishna Menon, too, had observed that "Non-alignment is more or less a residue of historical circumstances,…we cannot align with the west with its colonialism, and there is no question of course of joining the Soviet bloc".[8]

The Bandung Conference of 18–24 April 1955 in Indonesia was an Afro-Asian Conference, and it marked the beginning of the non-alignment movement although it was formally initiated at the Belgrade Conference in 1961. As Prof. V.P. Dutt observed that non-aligned countries "despite their inner contradictions, their oft-differing needs, their lack of military muscle and power, and their economic backwardness, have become some kind of a force to reckon with and at least one significant factor in international affairs".[9]